Stayman and Jacoby Transfers

The Stayman convention is used to find a 4-4 Major suit fit after one partner has opened 1NT or 2NT. Responder bids an artificial 2♣ and the Notrump bidder then bids a 4-card Major if she has one, or 2 or 3 ♦ otherwise.

The Jacoby Transfer convention is used to uncover a 5-3 Major suit fit after one partner has opened 1NT or 2NT. A response of ♦s asks opener to bid ♥s, a response of ♥s asks opener to bid ♠s.

The two conventions complement each other, that's why they are together in this set of practices.

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♦J

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: East
Lead: ♥5

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: South
Lead: ♣K

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: West
Lead: ♦Q

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♣10

Board: 6
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 2NT
Declarer: East
Lead: ♣4

Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

♠ Q 6 3
♥ Q 10 9 2
♦ A 7 6
♣ A K 3

♠ J 10 9 8
♥ 5 3
♦ K Q 4 2
♣ 6 5 2



♠ 5 4
♥ K 7 4
♦ J 10 9 8
♣ Q J 9 7

♠ A K 7 2
♥ A J 8 6
♦ 5 3
♣ 10 8 4

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1NT	Pass	2♣
Pass	2♥	Pass	4♥
All Pass			

4♥ by North
Lead: ♦J

SOUTH has four cards in each Major suit - this is an ideal situation for Stayman.

NORTH shows a ♥ suit and SOUTH immediately bids game in that suit.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ 10 5 3 ♥ J 9 4 ♦ Q J 9 4 ♣ J 9 3	
♠ K 9 7 4 ♥ K 8 6 2 ♦ 7 3 ♣ 8 6 5	N W E S	♠ A Q 8 2 ♥ A Q 3 ♦ K 10 6 2 ♣ A Q
	♠ J 6 ♥ 10 7 5 ♦ A 8 5 ♣ K 10 7 4 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		2NT	Pass
3♣	Pass	3♠	Pass
4♠			
All Pass			

4♠ by East
Lead: ♥5

Stayman convention works just fine after a 2NT opening, just at a higher level.

WEST knows that 6 points will be enough for game opposite EAST's 20-21, she just needs to find out if there is a 4-4 Major suit fit. There is, in ♠s.

Board 3
South Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ Q 9 8 7 4 ♥ A J 10 8 3 ♦ Q 6 ♣ 5	
♠ K 3 ♥ Q 6 5 2 ♦ K 9 4 3 ♣ K Q 7		♠ 6 5 2 ♥ 7 4 ♦ J 10 5 ♣ J 8 4 3 2
	♠ A J 10 ♥ K 9 ♦ A 8 7 2 ♣ A 10 9 6	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1NT
Pass	2♥	Pass	2♠
Pass	4♥	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

4♠ by South
Lead: ♣K

NORTH has five cards in each Major and SOUTH opens 1NT.

First NORTH bids 2♥, indicating a 5-card ♠ suit with the Transfer bid. Then, after SOUTH bids the obligatory 2♠, NORTH jumps to 4♥, promising enough strength for game, and also five ♥s to go with the five ♠s.

SOUTH prefers ♠s, so she corrects the contract to 4♠.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul

	♠ J 10 8 7 ♥ A 9 4 ♦ Q J 6 ♣ 10 5 2	
♠ A 9 6 ♥ K Q 6 2 ♦ K 5 3 2 ♣ K 8		♠ K Q 5 4 2 ♥ 8 7 ♦ A 8 ♣ Q 7 6 4
	♠ 3 ♥ J 10 5 3 ♦ 10 9 7 4 ♣ A J 9 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1NT	Pass	2♥	Pass
2♠	Pass	3NT	Pass
4♠			
All Pass			

4♠ by West
Lead: ♦Q

With 12 points and five ♠s, when EAST hears her partner open 1NT she knows there is a game - either 3NT or 4♠.

EAST first transfers WEST to ♠s, then jumps to 3NT, giving WEST the choice.

WEST has three ♠s, so he chooses 4♠, taking the 8-card Major fit.

Board 5
North Deals
None Vul

♠ K 8 6
♥ A 9 3
♦ K Q 8
♣ A K J 2

♠ J 10 9 5 3
♥ 8
♦ J 10 7 3
♣ Q 7 3



♠ A Q 2
♥ 10 6
♦ 6 5 4
♣ 10 8 6 5 4

♠ 7 4
♥ K Q J 7 5 4 2
♦ A 9 2
♣ 9

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2NT	Pass	3♦
Pass	3♥	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♥[2]	Pass	6♥
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 2 aces

6♥ by North
Lead: ♣10

After NORTH opens 2NT, SOUTH is pretty sure there will be a slam in ♥s. But, the contract should be played from the NORTH side so the opening lead doesn't go through any vulnerable ♠ holding NORTH might have.

SOUTH transfers NORTH to ♥s, then uses Blackwood to be sure they aren't off two Aces. Missing one Ace he settles for 6♥.

Board 6
East Deals
E-W Vul

♠ Q 7 4 3
♥ A 9 4
♦ Q 9 3
♣ A Q 3

♠ K 9 8 5
♥ Q 7
♦ K 8 7
♣ J 9 6 5



♠ A 6
♥ K J 5 3
♦ A 6 5 4
♣ K 10 7

♠ J 10 2
♥ 10 8 6 2
♦ J 10 2
♣ 8 4 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1NT	Pass
2♣	Pass	2♥	Pass
2NT			
All Pass			

2NT by East
Lead: ♣4

WEST has an invitational hand, (9 points), after EAST's 1NT opening. With a 4-card ♠ suit she uses Stayman.

EAST then shows his 4-card ♥ suit.

With no ♥ fit, WEST can only invite with 2NT, an invitation which EAST declines.